Britain's New Guide: Be Ready for 72 Hours on Your Own

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Imagine your phone, lights and fridge all stopped working. What would your family do for three days? Britain is now asking everyone that question, with a new national guide called 'Be Ready.' The guide explains how to look after yourself for 72 hours in an **emergency**, such as a big storm or a **cyberattack** that knocks out computers. It suggests keeping extra food, water, medicines and a torch at home. The last national **campaign** was in 1980, during the Cold War, when the government sent out **leaflets** called 'Protect and Survive.' People laughed at it. This time, officials say they want calm, useful tips, not scary messages. The head of the British Army, General Sir Roland Walker, told soldiers the world is in 'extreme **jeopardy**' and leaders need to talk honestly about risks. Disaster expert Lucy Easthope says the public wants reassurance. 'This is reawakening the idea that it's perfectly survivable,' she said. Other countries in Europe have also updated their advice. The guide's message is simple: a little planning now can make a hard few days much easier.

Word Treasure

cyberattack -- An attack on computers that stops them from working properly.
emergency -- A sudden dangerous event, like a big storm, when you may need help.
campaign -- A planned set of actions to tell people about something important.
leaflets -- Small printed sheets that give people information.
jeopardy -- Danger, or being in a risky situation.

Background you need

An emergency is a sudden dangerous event, like a big storm, when lights and phones may stop working.

Being ready means keeping extra food, water and a torch at home, so your family can manage for a few days.

Many countries give this advice so people know what to do and stay calm.

Break it down

WHO: Families in Britain, and experts like General Sir Roland Walker and Lucy Easthope.
WHAT: Britain has a new 'Be Ready' guide to help families cope on their own for 72 hours.
WHERE: At home in Britain, where the guide is being shared across the country.
WHY: So families know what to do in an emergency, like a big storm or a cyberattack.

Why it matters

If the lights went out at your house, knowing what your family has ready at home would help you feel safe instead of scared.

Test what you remember

1. How long should families be ready to cope on their own?

- (A) 48 hours
- (B) 24 hours
- (C) One week
- (D) 72 hours

2. What is the new guide called?

- (A) 'Protect and Survive'
- (B) 'Be Ready'
- (C) 'Stay Safe'
- (D) 'Be Prepared'

3. What should families keep at home?

- (A) A new phone and a TV
- (B) A car and a boat
- (C) Extra food, water, medicines and a torch
- (D) Money and jewels

4. When was the last national campaign?

- (A) 1960
- (B) 1996
- (C) 2004
- (D) 1980

5. What did General Walker say about the world?

- (A) It needs more soldiers
- (B) It has never been safer
- (C) It is in 'extreme jeopardy'
- (D) It should ignore all risks

6. What does the guide want people to do?

- (A) Move to another country
- (B) Panic and buy everything in the shops
- (C) Plan a little now to make hard days easier
- (D) Ignore all emergencies

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: C 4: D 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

1. General Sir Roland Walker: He says the world is in 'extreme jeopardy' and leaders need to talk honestly about risks.

2. Disaster expert Lucy Easthope: She says the public wants reassurance, and that the guide shows an emergency is 'perfectly survivable'.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):